



Mountains

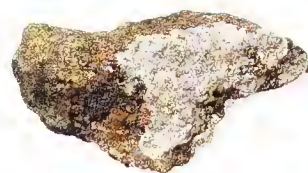


The high, rocky slopes of mountains are battered by cold winds and covered by heavy snow. They make a harsh habitat for animals and plants.

Mountain plants

To survive the harsh conditions, mountain plants have special shapes and parts.

Trees cannot grow above the tree line.



Lichen

Lichens grow high up because they can survive extreme cold.

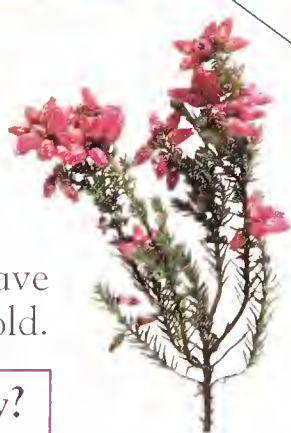
Coniferous forests grow on the higher slopes.

Poor, thin soil



Rhododendron

Thick, shiny leaves save this plant from the cold.



Deciduous forests grow on the lower slopes.

Bell heather

The tiny leaves of this heather can withstand strong winds.



Rock rose

Rock roses grow close to the ground to stay out of the wind.

Mountain animals



Vultures' large wings allow them to glide on strong mountain winds.



A bobcat's spotted coat helps it blend in with its rocky mountain home.



Chinchillas have thick fur coats to protect them from the cold.



Mountain goats have specially shaped hooves to help them clamber over rocks.

Did you know?

In 1963, a volcanic island suddenly appeared in the sea. Called Surtsey, it is now home to plants.



Volcano

When volcanoes erupt, they shoot out molten rock. This can build a mountain in less than a week!

